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The 30-Day Shadow Pilot

Run AR Match Pro alongside the current process. Change nothing. Measure everything. Convert on evidence.

Why "shadow" wins the deal

Asking a finance team to switch cash application tools mid-quarter is a six-month enterprise sale. Asking them to **drop the same three files they already export into a second browser tab once a week** is a yes on the first call. The pilot never touches their ledger — their team keeps posting exactly as today, and the comparison data sells the conversion.

Entry criteria (qualify before starting)

Criterion	Threshold
ERP	SAP (FBL5N exports available) or NetSuite; D365 F&O acceptable
Payment volume	≤ 15,000 check/ACH/wire lines per month (≤ ~3,500 per weekly session)
Open invoice book	≤ 100,000 open items
Files obtainable	Weekly open-invoice export + bank statement; remittances and delivery report optional but boost results
Champion	One named AR analyst or supervisor who runs the weekly session (≤ 30 min/week)

Week 0 — Setup (one 45-minute call)

Send the Security & Privacy Data Sheet and the pilot agreement before the call. On the call: (1) 10-minute Demo Mode walkthrough on synthetic data — no customer data needed; (2) download the ARMP Invoice Import Template and confirm their FBL5N / saved-search export maps (it does, natively, for SAP); (3) agree the weekly session slot; (4) baseline capture: have them log hours spent on manual cash application this week and their current unapplied-cash balance. **The baseline is the ROI denominator — do not skip it.**

Weeks 1–2 — Shadow runs

Each week the champion imports the invoice book, bank file, and any remittances, clicks Run Auto Match, works the Needs Attention queue, and exports the posting file — **but does not post it**. Capture per session (the Reports tab shows all of these): auto-match rate, dollars auto-applied, exception count and types, and minutes spent in ARMP. Vendor reviews each session async and tunes name normalization or templates within 24h. Practical guardrails: keep bank files ≤ 2,500 lines per session (split by week or account — the app enforces this), and on books above ~13K invoices export before closing the tab (the app reminds you).

Week 3 — Parallel verification (the proof week)

Their team completes manual cash application as normal. The same files run through ARMP. Then reconcile the two line by line: every ARMP allocation is compared against what the team actually posted. Target: **100% agreement on auto-applied lines** (conservative matching means ARMP routes anything uncertain to Cash on Account rather than guessing), with ARMP's exception notes ("COA for SO …", delivery-bridge chains) matched against the analyst's own research notes. Any disagreement gets a root-cause writeup — this is where trust is won.

Week 4 — ROI readout and conversion

Metric	Source	Sell line
Auto-match rate	Reports tab, weeks 1–3 average	"X% of your cash applied itself"
Hours: manual vs ARMP	Baseline log vs in-ARMP minutes	hours saved × loaded analyst cost × 12 months
Verification agreement	Week 3 reconciliation	"and it agreed with your own team 100% on auto-applies"
Unapplied cash aging	Their own AR trial balance	faster application → cleaner AR, better DSO
Exception quality	Needs Attention notes	each exception arrives pre-researched with the posting note written

Readout meeting attendees: champion + Controller/VP Finance. Close: pilot pricing honored for annual commitment signed within 14 days of readout. If metrics missed target, extend two weeks free with a named fix list — a miss handled transparently converts more often than a shaky win.

Exit criteria

Convert when: auto-match ≥ 80% by week 3, week-3 verification agreement 100% on auto-applies, champion time ≤ 30 min/session. Walk away (gracefully) when: file exports can’t be produced weekly, volumes exceed the entry criteria, or no champion attends two consecutive sessions — and leave the door open with the data sheet on file.